

paings that have not only promoted awareness but generated enormous sums of money for their causes.

One such campaign was the ALS Ice Bucket Campaign. It had all the makings of a great social media campaign – video, celebrity involvement, the charity aspect and very importantly timing. Not many people would consider dumping a bucket of ice water over their heads in winter. This well thought out campaign generated over a \$100 million.

Another was the Friendsy Campaign by Air Asia. The airline had just launched a new flight from Australia and were up against some stiff competition. Being a budget airline they lack funds but needed to create brand recognition quickly. They launched a Facebook competition to give away (nearly) a free plane. The competition allowed you to choose 302 of your friends and tag them in a seating plan. Not only did they double the amount of flights booked but their Facebook fan base grew by 30% i.e. 2 million people. The estimated PR generated was \$1.5 million.

A recent campaign that shows the importance of good content is Buzzfeed's Tasty social pages. Tasty creates short and creative how-to videos on food. With these simple recipe videos they have managed to get over 14,000,000 followers and more than a million views per video. Videos make it easy and interesting to watch and the simplicity of the recipes makes everyone want to try them out.

Key components of social media marketing

- Social Media Optimization (SMO) –The process drawing new and unique visitors to a website. This is very similar to Search Engine Optimization (SEO). It can be done by adding social media links to content. Or by promoting activity through social media by updating statuses, tweets, blog posts.
- Social Customer Relationship Management (Social CRM) – Getting direct feedback from customers while making the company seem accessible and approachable. When a customer feels heard by a company he or she is more likely to endorse the company.
- Selection and setting up of various social media platforms eg: Facebook, Youtube, Twitter, etc. Knowing where your target audience operates most. This can be based on age, gender even where you live.
- Metrics, Measurement and Analytics –Just putting a social marketing strategy in place is not enough. How do you know if it is working? How do you measure the effect that it is having? Setting up Web